Over 2.5 goals: V4 report

Mon 02 Nov 2026 to Thu 05 Nov 2026 (european). All times UK.

Executive summary

5 fixtures analysed: High 0, Medium 0, Weak 0, rejected 5. Selected fixtures with both attacks scoring 2+ in 3 of 5 or better: 0.

Selection engine: the validated model (V4 lock, unchanged since 19 Oct 2026). Out of sample it hit 69% in High (729 fixtures), 64% across all selected (2,518), 54% rejected (5,017). Those are band rates, not the chance of any one fixture. Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ counts are shown on every card as supporting evidence; both attacks at 3 of 5+ adds about three points inside the bands and is highlighted, not required.

Selected fixtures ranked by model score (up to 20)

#	Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	Home sc2+ / let2+	Away sc2+ / let2+	Both 3/5+	BTTS	Confidence	Division	Main risk (Over 2.5 = Yes for every row)

Grouped shortlist (date, competition, confidence, model score)

Fixture cards

Rejected fixtures, with the model's reason

Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	H sc2+	H let2+	A sc2+	A let2+	Model	Reason
Mon 02 Nov 19:45	Ligue 1	Lorient v Stade Brestois 29	1/5	2/5	1/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 1/5
Mon 02 Nov 17:00	Super Lig	Gençlerbirliği S.K. v Alanyaspor	1/5	4/5	2/5	3/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5
Mon 02 Nov 20:00	La Liga	Deportivo La Coruna v Osasuna	1/5	1/5	2/5	3/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5
Mon 02 Nov 20:15	Primeira Liga	Benfica v Alverca	4/5	1/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 4/5 and 2/5
Mon 02 Nov 20:15	Primeira Liga	GIL Vicente v Vitória SC	1/5	1/5	1/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 1/5

Data coverage and limitations

• Fixtures analysed: 5. Every count is taken from the stored final score of each match (fixture ID, teams, score); the five scorelines are printed on each card.

• Form sample: each side's last five completed league games this season, cup ties excluded; venue rows use the last five league games at that venue, sample size shown when fewer.

• Not covered by API Sports for 2026-27: Northern Premier, Isthmian and Southern League Division One. 'England V2' is not an API Sports competition and was not included.

• Scored first / conceded after leading: needs match event timelines, not pulled (one call per match, no history). Not shown. First-half goals: available from half-time scores, not yet on the card.

• Injuries and suspensions: the API returned lists for a minority of fixtures this week; nothing is inferred where it returned none. Squad rotation in cup ties is not assessed.

• Opposition strength: each side's opponents' scoring versus the division is held in the analysis file (oq columns) but is not part of the alignment score.

• Competitions in scope with no fixtures in the window: Bundesliga, Eredivisie, Scottish Premiership.

Methodology (V4 lock)

• Selection: gradient-boosted model on each side's last-5 league counts (goals, 3+, 2+ scored, 2+ conceded, clean sheets, failed to score, BTTS), last-3 venue counts and the division's 3+ share. Trained on 2023-24 and 2024-25, validated on 2025-26; cut points from validation deciles. High = top decile; Medium = next two; Weak = bottom quarter of Medium; rejected below.

• Out of sample (Jan to Jun 2026 and Aug to Oct 2026, 7,535 fixtures): High 69% (729), Selected 64% (2,518), rejected 54% (5,017). Band rates, not per-fixture probabilities.

• Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ are shown for both sides as evidence. Both attacks 3 of 5+ is highlighted (Selected with it 66%, High 71%) but never required: High fixtures failing a 2-of-5 attacking rule hit 73% on 222 fixtures.

• BTTS: YES when the pattern is 'both teams contribute' (two scoring routes, each side scoring in 4 of 5 and conceding in 3 of 5); likelihood from a second validated model (High 61%, Medium 55%, Low 50%). A lean, not a pick.

• V2 and V3 alignment scores were tested (62 to 66% at comparable sizes) and are not used for selection. Full tables in over25_backtest_baseline.md.

• No averages anywhere. Nothing inferred for missing data. Every count comes from stored final scores; the five scorelines are printed on each card.